

iOS 4.1 Beta released

Apple has released a beta version of iOS SDK 4.1 for developers

\$3.25 billion net profit

Apple reported a net profit of \$3.25 billion on revenue of \$15.7 billion this quarter

Another interesting aspect in the email app is threaded emails. You will get a small box with a number indicating the number of conversations that have happened over that mail. Clicking it, will open up all the previous mails as well. Also you have the option of opening up attachment in third party apps.

Customising Spotlight Search

Mobile Safari has added quite a lot of options here. You can customise the Spotlight search (Settings > General > Spotlight Search) to search the iPhone/iPod based on your preference. For example, if you want the OS to search your Contacts first, then your Mail or Notes etc., for the search query, you can arrange it accordingly. Also Mobile Safari has added Wikipedia and search engine support to expedite search.

Improved iPod app

The iPod app has undergone some interesting additions. The iOS4 update allows you to make custom playlists, instead of just having the legacy On-The-Go playlist in the previous iOS installment. You can edit a current playlist by adding or deleting tracks from it (playlist_name > Edit > + (for adding tracks), - (for deleting them)) or create a brand new playlist (Music > Playlist > Add Playlist...) iPhone OS 4 now features the album art, release date, number of songs and album length at the top



More playlists in the Music player

of the page when an album has been selected.

iBooks on iPhone and iPod touch

'Who reads books on their mobile phone?' did we hear. Well going by the way Kindle is now available across all mobile platforms, it is safe to assume that a lot of books are read on mobile screens. With Apple having launched its own iBook store to compete with Amazon's Kindle, it was no surprise to find an iBook app along with the iOS4. iBook has been optimised for the mobile screen but in terms of functionality it is similar to its iPad counterpart. You can read your PDFs in iBook or order ebooks online. It allows you to change the background from white to sepia; change the font in the iBook app; add a bookmark and make notes by tapping on a section of the text. Further reading on this feature revealed easy syncing with your iPad if you are on the same WiFi network.

Camera features

iOS4 has enabled 5x digital zoom in the camera section. This we felt was not such a great addition considering, digital zoom is not a feature that will give you great results. For the video camera, you can decide your point of focus by tapping the region of the screen you want to focus on. Again this feature is not a brand new feature, considering many other phones already offer this.

An interesting addition is the ability to decide the resize photos while attaching them in the mail. Another feature which is interesting but not novel is geo-tagging photographs. This feature is very similar to Footprints app of HTC phones, which helps you to tag

a particular photo to a place. iOS4 can pull the geo location data attached to the photo and show them on a map.

Word Editing

You can now select text, copy it, paste it or replace it just like you would on your desktop. iOS4 has added support for Bluetooth keyboards, which can also replicate the Command + A, + C, + V on the iPhone or iPod. But this feature is ideal only for emergency use, as using a keyboard and viewing the output on the small screen just seems foolish and also you cannot carry your Bluetooth keyboard the way you carry your iPhone or iPod.

Instead of auto-correcting spellings to what Apple thinks is the right way to spell, you now get a red underline and on tapping it, you have the option to select the correct spelling or leave it as is.

Features that didn't make it: Flash

Apple and Adobe have had huge rows over this. According to Jobs, Apple would be more willing to adopt HTML5, CSS and JavaScript which are all open standards and bypass the need to download third party browser plug-ins (like Flash). Jobs also claims that Flash is not suited for mobile devices as it sucks up battery life and has security holes.

Social media integration

This is one feature which we felt was the most obvious one, which iOS4 missed out on. Integrating social media with contacts, is a feature that has existed on many phones which definitely reduces navigation time.

Bluetooth media transfer

Apple iOS4 still does not allow Bluetooth transfer to devices other than Apple products – a bit archaic.

On the whole this update has been great. But we feel some features like multi-tasking, geo tagging photographs introduced in iOS4 have come in a bit late and were already present on many other devices. However, features like iBook, unified email, make up for wait. 

Features	Apple iOS4	Android 2.2 aka FroYo
Multi-Tasking	Limited	Full
Number of apps	over 230,000	reaching 100,000
Flash Support	None	Yes. FroYo supports Flash 10.1 beta
Hot-Spot capability	None	Yes. WiFi can be shared by upto 8 users
Video Chat	Natively support on iPhone4	None
Unified Email	Yes	None. But threading is available in Gmail
UI customization	Only wallpapers	Everything from multiple wallpapers, to skins, themes and widgets

iOS4 vs. FroYo : Feature for feature comparison